

Describe the Scene

DIFFICULT PRACTICE

NAME _____ DATE SET _____ DUE _____

"Describe an empty theatre, ten minutes after everyone has left."

No characters, no dialogue, no plot. Build the picture entirely from what is left behind and what the space itself seems to hold now that no one is watching.

The hardest version of this task is describing absence itself — not just the room, but the feeling of everyone having just gone. A weak answer lists objects. A strong answer makes the emptiness feel active, almost like a presence of its own.

YOUR WRITING

CHECKLIST — GO OVER IT AGAIN

1. **Is there a person hiding in this description?** Check you haven't accidentally introduced a character or dialogue — that breaks the task.
2. At least 4 of the 5 senses, one extended metaphor for the emptiness itself, and one moment of personification.
3. At least one very short sentence (2–4 words) for impact, and a shape that moves from the edge of the space inward to one lasting image.
4. No clichés about theatres or empty rooms ("silence so thick you could cut it," "as still as a graveyard").
5. Check tense stays consistent throughout — present tense works well for this kind of scene, but pick one and keep it.
6. **Ending lands on a single image**, not a summary of what you've already described.